STUDENT BRIEFING — DISTRIBUTE ON CARNIVAL DAY

🏊 Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing

Read this before you enter the water. It will take 2 minutes and could save a life.

📋 Today's Rules — Everyone Must Know These

🏊 **Stay in your designated area.** Only enter the water when instructed by your teacher or event marshal. Do not enter the warm-up or racing lanes unless it is your turn.

🚫 **No diving in shallow water.** Check depth before any entry. Feet-first entry only unless you are in a designated dive start lane confirmed by staff.

👀 **Always have a buddy.** Know who your buddy is. If you can't see them, tell a teacher immediately.

🆘 **Signal for help if you need it.** Raise ONE arm. Do not be embarrassed — it is always better to ask for help.

📵 **Phones away near the pool edge.** Distraction is a major factor in pool incidents. Phones are for spectator areas only.

💊 **Medical conditions.** If you have asthma, a heart condition, or any health issue — check in with your teacher before the carnival begins. Do not swim if you feel unwell.

🏃 **No running on the pool deck.** Walk at all times. Wet pool decks cause falls that result in serious injuries every year.

📍 Know These Locations

- **First aid station:** _____ *(teacher to fill in)*
- **AED (defibrillator):** _____
- **Emergency exit:** _____
- **Teacher in charge:** _____
- **Lifeguard on duty:** _____

✅ Before You Swim

- Know your event number and heat
- Have goggles & swim cap ready
- Apply sunscreen (outdoor pool)
- Stay hydrated — drink water regularly
- Warm up gently — no cold water shock
- Tell your teacher if you feel unwell at any point

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⚠️ If You See Someone in Trouble

- **Shout** to attract a lifeguard or teacher's attention immediately — loudly and clearly: "HELP — SWIMMER IN TROUBLE!"
- **Do NOT jump in** to help — alert trained staff only. Untrained rescuers become casualties themselves.
- **Throw** the nearest buoyant object (life ring, kickboard, pool noodle) if the person is near the edge
- If no staff are immediately visible, one person calls 000 while others continue shouting for adult help

000

Emergency: Call 000

Your location: name of pool/school + suburb + street address. What happened. How many people are injured. Whether they are breathing. **Stay on the line.**

I have read and understood the Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing:

STUDENT NAME	CLASS	DATE	STUDENT SIGNATURE

TEACHER REFERENCE — NOT FOR STUDENT DISTRIBUTION

🍏 Carnival Day Teacher Checklist

Complete all pre-carnival checks. Keep this document accessible during the event. Review DE Swimming excursion policy annually.

📋 Pre-Carnival Preparation (1 week before)

- [ ] Confirm venue has qualified lifeguard(s) in attendance for duration of carnival
- [ ] Confirm AED location at the venue — test that it is operational
- [ ] Collect and review all student medical forms (asthma, cardiac, epilepsy, allergies)
- [ ] Identify students who cannot swim or have water anxiety — assign buddy and inform all supervising staff
- [ ] Brief all supervising staff on emergency procedures and their roles
- [ ] Confirm first aid kit is stocked and present on the day
- [ ] Distribute student safety briefing sheet — collect signed acknowledgements
- [ ] Complete and file the DE risk management documentation
- [ ] Confirm student-to-supervisor ratios comply with DE requirements
- [ ] Identify emergency evacuation routes at the venue

⚠️ Supervision Ratios (DE Policy)

- Check current DE Swimming Policy for approved ratios
- At minimum: one qualified first aider must be present at all times
- Designated Water Watcher: one adult whose sole responsibility is scanning the water — no other tasks
- Rotate water watcher role every 15–20 minutes to maintain vigilance

📍 Venue Layout — Fill In On Arrival

AED location: _____

First aid room: _____

Lifeguard station: _____

Emergency exit: _____

Venue phone: _____

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- Never leave pool area unsupervised even momentarily

DE Swimming Policy ↗

Pool address (for 000): _____

👥 Staff Roles on Carnival Day

🎯 Event Coordinator

- Overall oversight of running order
- Liaises with venue staff
- Manages timetable and results
- Point of contact for parents

👁 Water Watcher

- Scans the water continuously
- No other tasks while watching
- Rotates every 15–20 min
- Calls 000 or signals lifeguard if needed

🩺 First Aider

- Trained and qualified staff only
- Knows AED location
- Manages medical kit
- Responds immediately if called

📋 On-the-Day Checklist (morning of carnival)

- [ ] Roll call — confirm all students present and accounted for
- [ ] Collect any new medical information from parents on arrival
- [ ] Brief all students with the Safety Briefing sheet (or read aloud)
- [ ] Walk venue — confirm AED, first aid room, emergency exits are accessible
- [ ] Confirm lifeguard is on deck and briefed on school group
- [ ] Assign Water Watcher — brief on role and rotation
- [ ] Confirm non-swimmers are identified with coloured caps or wristbands
- [ ] Run brief DRS ABCD refresher with student helpers/water safety monitors

🚨 If an Incident Occurs

1. **SHOUT for the lifeguard** — they are the first responder in a pool environment
2. **Clear the pool** — all other students out of water immediately
3. **Call 000** — one designated person only; others manage the crowd
4. **Begin DRS ABCD** if lifeguard is not immediately available
5. **Send someone to the entrance** to guide emergency services in
6. **Notify school administration** as soon as emergency services are en route

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7. **Do not move the casualty** unless they are in immediate further danger
8. **Document everything** — time, observations, actions taken — as soon as incident is stable

✅ Post-Carnival Obligations

- Complete a written incident report for ANY first aid treatment (including minor)
- Notify school administration of any incidents on the same day
- Serious incidents must be reported to DE — follow your school's Critical Incident protocol
- Debrief with supervising staff — identify any improvements for next year
- Return risk management documentation to the office
- Reference: DE Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy ↗

QUICK REFERENCE — PRINT & POST POOLSIDE

🚨 Emergency Reference Card

Print at A4 and laminate. Post at poolside and first aid station. Accessible to all staff.

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Emergency Services — Call 000

Pool name: _____ | Street: _____ | Suburb: _____

Tell them: location, what happened, number of casualties, whether breathing. **Stay on the line.**

🩺 DRS ABCD — Emergency Action Plan

D	R	S	A	B	C	D
DANGER	RESPONSE	SEND 000	AIRWAY	BREATHING	CPR	DEFIB

CPR: 30 chest compressions + 2 rescue breaths. Hard and fast, 100–120 bpm, 5–6cm depth. Continue until ambulance arrives.

🏊 Pool Incident — Immediate Steps

1. Shout for lifeguard immediately
2. Clear the pool of all students
3. Call 000
4. Lifeguard/first aider begins DRS ABCD
5. Send person to entrance for ambulance
6. Keep bystanders clear
7. Do not move casualty unless in danger

📍 Key Contacts — Fill In Before Carnival

Lifeguard name: _____

Lifeguard mobile: _____

Teacher in charge: _____

TIC mobile: _____

School office: _____

AED location: _____

🩺 AED (Defibrillator) — How to Use

1. **Ensure the casualty is out of the water** and lying on a dry surface before using
2. Turn on the AED — it will give voice instructions; follow them exactly

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3. Attach the pads as shown in the diagram on the pads themselves
4. Stand clear when the AED analyses the heart rhythm
5. If a shock is advised, ensure no-one is touching the casualty, then press the shock button
6. Continue CPR between AED instructions until ambulance arrives

AEDs are safe — they will only deliver a shock if the heart needs it.

📋 Throw, Don't Go — Rescue Hierarchy

1. **Talk** — call instructions from poolside: "Float on your back! Raise your arm!"
2. **Reach** — extend a kickboard, pool noodle, or pole from the edge
3. **Throw** — throw the life ring or any buoyant object with a line attached
4. **Go** — enter the water ONLY if lifeguard-trained, never alone, always with flotation

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Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing · Victorian Secondary HPE · DE Swimming Policy: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

St John Vic: stjohnvic.com.au · LSV: lsv.com.au

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